

ELEGANT

1. Passage anchor

> “It looked ****elegant****, felt solid in my hand...”

Passage meaning

****elegant**** = attractive in a refined, tasteful, and graceful way

****優雅的；雅緻的；高雅的****

Here, the fountain pen looks stylish and refined rather than flashy.

Practice

1. The pen had a simple but ****elegant**** design.

那支筆的設計簡單但很****雅緻****。

2. She wore an ****elegant**** black dress.

她穿了一條****優雅的****黑色連身裙。

Core meanings of ELEGANT

2. elegant — refined and stylish in appearance

= attractive in a graceful, tasteful, and sophisticated way

****優雅的；雅緻的；高雅的****

Examples

1. The room was simple and ****elegant****.

房間簡單而****雅緻****。

2. He chose an ****elegant**** watch.

他選了一隻****高雅的****手錶。

This is the exact passage sense.

3. elegant design

= design that is visually refined, balanced, and tasteful

****雅緻的設計；優雅的設計****

Examples

1. The phone has an ****elegant design****.
這部手機有很****雅緻的設計****。
2. The building combines simplicity with ****elegant design****.
那棟建築把簡潔與****優雅設計****結合起來。

Graceful movement / manner

4. elegant — graceful in movement or behavior

= moving or behaving with smoothness, grace, and poise
****優雅的；從容有風度的****

Examples

1. She made an ****elegant entrance****.
她以很****優雅的姿態****進場。
2. The dancer's movements were ****elegant****.
舞者的動作十分****優美優雅****。

Refined expression / language

5. elegant — polished and well expressed

= expressed clearly, smoothly, and attractively
****精練的；優美的；表達漂亮的****

Examples

1. He gave an ****elegant explanation**** of the idea.
他對這個概念作了很****精練漂亮的解釋****。
2. The essay is written in an ****elegant style****.
這篇文章以****優美的文風****寫成。

Simple and effective solution

6. elegant — simple, clever, and effective

In technical, mathematical, scientific, and design contexts:

= solving a problem in a simple, efficient, and intellectually satisfying way

****簡潔巧妙的；漂亮的；精妙的****

Examples

1. The engineer proposed an ****elegant solution****.

工程師提出了一個****簡潔巧妙的解決方案****。

2. It is an ****elegant proof****.

這是一個****漂亮而精妙的證明****。

This is an important distinct modern sense.

7. elegant solution

= solution that achieves the desired result with simplicity and efficiency

****簡潔巧妙的解法；漂亮的解決方案****

Examples

1. They found an ****elegant solution**** to the problem.

他們找到了一個****簡潔巧妙的解決方案****。

2. The best design is often the most ****elegant solution****.

最好的設計往往是最****簡潔有效的方案****。

Related forms

8. elegance

A. refined beauty

****優雅；雅緻****

1. The room has a quiet ****elegance****.

房間帶有一種低調的****優雅****。

B. simplicity and effectiveness

****簡潔之美；精妙****

2. Engineers admired the ****elegance of the solution****.
工程師欣賞這個方案的****精妙簡潔****。

9. elegantly

= in an elegant way

****優雅地；雅緻地；簡潔漂亮地****

Examples

1. She was ****elegantly dressed****.
她穿著得很****優雅****。
2. The problem was ****elegantly solved****.
問題被****簡潔漂亮地解決****了。

High-value collocations

10. elegant appearance

= refined and tasteful look

****優雅的外觀****

Examples

1. The pen has an ****elegant appearance****.
那支筆外觀很****雅緻****。
2. The building maintains an ****elegant appearance****.
那棟建築保持著****優雅的外觀****。

11. elegant style

= graceful or refined style

****優雅風格；高雅風格****

Examples

1. She has an ****elegant style****.
她有一種****優雅的風格****。
2. The restaurant is known for its ****elegant style****.
那家餐廳以****高雅風格****聞名。

12. elegant simplicity

= beauty or effectiveness that comes from being simple rather than complicated
****簡潔之美；簡約而優雅****

Examples

1. I liked the ****elegant simplicity**** of the design.
我喜歡這個設計的****簡潔之美****。
2. The room's appeal comes from its ****elegant simplicity****.
房間的吸引力來自它的****簡約優雅****。

Key contrasts

13. elegant vs beautiful

****beautiful****

= generally very attractive
****美麗的****

****elegant****

= attractive in a refined, graceful, tasteful way
****優雅的；雅緻的****

Something can be beautiful without being elegant.

14. elegant vs stylish

****stylish****

= fashionable or attractive in current style
****時尚的；有型的****

****elegant****

= refined and tasteful, often less dependent on fashion trends

****優雅的；高雅的****

Compare:

> a ****stylish**** jacket

> 時尚外套

> an ****elegant**** evening dress

> 優雅晚裝

15. elegant vs fancy

****fancy****

= decorative, elaborate, expensive-looking, or special

****華麗的；花巧的****

****elegant****

= refined and tasteful, often with restraint

****雅緻的；優雅的****

This distinction fits the passage especially well.

The pen is:

> ****elegant****

> → refined and tasteful

not necessarily:

> ****fancy****

> → elaborate or showy

16. elegant vs flashy

****flashy****

= designed to attract attention strongly, often through bright, showy, or exaggerated appearance

****花巧的；炫目的；張揚的****

****elegant****

= refined, tasteful, and often understated

****優雅的；低調高雅的****

This is a major passage contrast.

17. elegant vs graceful

****graceful****

= moving or shaped in a smooth, attractive way

****優美的；優雅的****

****elegant****

= broader; can describe appearance, design, writing, behavior, or solutions

A dancer may be ****graceful****; a mathematical proof can be ****elegant**** but not usually graceful.

18. elegant vs sophisticated

****sophisticated****

= refined, advanced, cultured, or complex in a developed way

****成熟高雅的；精密的****

****elegant****

= refined and pleasing, often emphasizing simplicity and grace

A system can be sophisticated but not elegant if it is overly complex.

19. elegant vs simple

****simple****

= not complicated

****簡單的****

****elegant****

in technical contexts:

= simple ****and**** clever/effective

So:

> simple solution

> 簡單解法

does not automatically mean:

> elegant solution

> 簡潔巧妙的漂亮解法

Meaning map

The central concept of **elegant** is:

refined quality without awkwardness or excess

From this develop:

Appearance

elegant pen / dress

→ **優雅的；雅緻的**

Movement

elegant movement

→ **優美從容的**

Expression

elegant writing/explanation

→ **精練優美的**

Technical reasoning

elegant solution/proof

→ **簡潔巧妙的；精妙的**

Noun

elegance

→ **優雅；精妙**

The passage uses the visual/design branch:

> **It looked elegant**

> → **它看起來很雅緻、很有品味**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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elegant — appearance	外觀精緻、有品味而不俗氣；優雅的 / 雅緻的
elegant design	視覺上簡潔、協調而有品味的設計
elegant — movement/manner	動作或舉止流暢、有風度；優雅的
elegant — expression/style	語言或表達精練、流暢而漂亮
elegant — technical solution	以簡單、有效而巧妙的方法解決問題；簡潔巧妙的
elegant solution	同時具簡潔、效率與巧思的解決方案
elegance — beauty	優雅、雅緻的品質
elegance — technical	一個解法或設計的簡潔、精妙之處
elegantly	以優雅、雅緻或簡潔漂亮的方式
elegant simplicity	因簡約而產生的優雅 / 簡潔之美

Passage recap

> “It looked ****elegant****, felt solid in my hand...”

Here:

****elegant**** = ****attractive in a refined, tasteful, and understated way****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****優雅的****

* ****雅緻的****

* ****高雅的****

Natural contextual translation:

****它看起來很雅緻，拿在手上也很有份量。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****elegant****

= ****attractive and refined in a tasteful, graceful way****

****優雅的；雅緻的；高雅的****

The most important passage contrast is:

> ****elegant****

> → 有品味、精緻、低調高雅

versus:

> ****flashy****

> → 張揚、搶眼、花巧

That distinction fits the fountain pen perfectly: its appeal comes from ****refinement rather than showiness****.